people who live in it. Throughout this long career of mine I've been out of the country for long periods of time, and I can never wait to get back to the Mother City. It's such a beautiful place. I've never once flown into Cape Town where people on the aeroplane haven't started looking out the windows 10 minutes before landing, wanting to catch a glimpse of the place. I've lived here all my life, and I *always* look out the window. It's just an amazing place, and I can't see myself ever leaving it.

I doubt whether I'll be married in 20 years' time – who knows: if it happens, it happens. I'll be in my mid-fifties, and my son Rashard will be in his early thirties. Perhaps I would have had the pleasure of watching him play some form of representative sport for South Africa – and, hey, who knows, I might have a couple of grandchildren by then too. Whatever happens to me, and whatever I end up doing, as long as I am still able to be the same Herschelle Gibbs, I'll be happy. Whatever comes my way from now on, I'll be ready for it. I'll embrace it and give it the same amount of passion with which I've always lived my life.

Finally, at least remember me for this …

Brian Lara's words, on his retirement from international cricket in 2007, have always stuck with me. After his last game for the West Indies at the 2007 World Cup, he was asked in an interview how he'd like to be remembered. He didn't say anything about being remembered for scoring 11 953 Test runs at an average of 52.88, and 10 405 ODI runs at an average of 40.48. Nor did he mention his record Test score of 400 not out. None of that.

His reply was to ask the crowd, 'Did I entertain?' and he's right on the money. Professional sportspeople exist only because of the fans who watch them at the games or on TV. Ultimately, they are the source of all the money. To generate TV rights or ticket sales, you have to put on a good show. If we don't entertain the fans, then they don't watch, and the whole professional sports model collapses.

So, I can only echo Brian's question: Have I entertained? I hope so, because it's what I have always set out to do. If I walk off the field after scoring a 100 – be it off 50 balls or 200 balls – I'm probably the most satisfied person in the ground, because I got to entertain the crowd on that particular day.